

to ignore the rivals. “Competition in India is surely intensifying, especially from domestic players such as Tata Motors and Mahindra & Mahindra, which have strengthened their position in segments like SUVs and electric vehicles (EVs). The long-standing position of many original equipment manufacturers (OEMs) is being challenged as these players gain momentum with their compelling offerings,” says Harshvardhan Sharma, Group Head-Automotive Tech & Innovation Group at Nomura Research Institute. The company’s profit slipped 6.9% to ₹5,640 crore in FY25 as against ₹6,060 crore in FY24.

The decline has not gone unnoticed in the group’s headquarters in South Korea. In April, the parent, Hyundai Motor Corporation, sent a team to analyse the reasons for the decline and is reportedly keeping a close watch on India, the world’s third-largest automobile market that accounts for 16.8% of Hyundai Motor Corporation’s global volumes after the US (33%), South Korea (19.5%) and Europe (18.4%). India is also among the fastest growing markets for Hyundai; it accounts

for 20% volumes and 8% operating profit, says a note by research firm UBS. As per S&P Global, India accounts for 8.44% of the global revenue for Hyundai Motor Corporation.

Given India’s importance, Hyundai has worked out a three-pronged strategy featuring product offensive, export pivot and capacity ramp-up to reignite growth. Will it work?

NEW MODELS

Hyundai Motor India plans to launch as many as 26 new models—20 internal combustion engine (ICE) and six EVs—by 2030 in its most aggressive product push yet. While many will be refreshed versions of existing models, the automaker also intends to introduce seven-eight new models. The product offensive starts as early as October this year.

A big portion of the upcoming portfolio will be SUVs, which account for over 69% of Hyundai’s sales in India. The models slated to be launched in the near term include Hyundai Bayon Crossover, Exter facelift, Verna facelift, a new i20, Alcazar, an electric hatchback and Palisade Hybrid, already available in several countries.

“The Indian car market is evolving rapidly with consumers becoming increasingly aspirational and value driven. At Hyundai Motor India, we are closely attuned to these changing dynamics. Given the rising demand, we expect SUVs to continue dominating the passenger vehicle segment. We will keep strengthening our SUV portfolio and pushing premiumisation,” says

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16.8% **INDIA'S SHARE IN HYUNDAI GLOBAL SALES BY VOLUMES**

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...THE COMEBACK PLAN

▶ Hyundai plans to launch 26 new models, including six EVs, by 2030; plus, three-four hybrid models in the next few years

▶ Near-term line-up includes Hyundai Bayon Crossover, Exter facelift, Verna facelift, new i20, Alcazar, an electric hatchback

and Palisade Hybrid. A hydrogen-powered model is also in the works

▶ With an upcoming plant in Pune, plans to increase capacity to 1.1 million units a year by FY30

▶ The company is strengthening its

position in the SUV segment, placing emphasis on feature-rich offerings and expanding the sales and service network, with a particular focus on rural regions

▶ Targeting 30% exports by 2030, up from 22% at present